



CITY workers for San Fernando cover and remove the statue Thursday at Cesar E. Chavez Memorial Park. KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

Cesar Chavez’s erasure is fast underway

California is removing historic figure’s name and image from public places without delay.

By KAREN GARCIA AND MELISSA GOMEZ

It took three decades of battles and lobbying for Cesar Chavez’s name and likeness to grace hundreds of buildings, roads, parks and schools.

It is taking just days for them to come down.

In the two days after allegations emerged that the famed farmworker rights leader and Chicano figure sexually assaulted minors and fellow laborer Dolores Huerta, Chavez is being erased at an unprecedented rate. This is especially true in California, where his fight for agricultural workers’ rights was cemented in state history.

In San Fernando, a completely covered Chavez statue was pulled off its pedestal and put into storage. Murals depicting Chavez in Los Angeles were unceremoniously painted over. In Fresno, the City Council voted to strip his name from a major street — just three years after its controversial decision to rebrand it in his honor. Soon, the old street names — Kings Canyon Road, Ventura Street and California Avenue — will return to the nearly 10-mile-long corridor.

California officials and activists said they were shocked by the allegations brought forth in a New York Times investigation and felt it was essential to act right away. But the speed of the changes is unprecedented.

Reassessing place names as the dark side of history becomes more apparent is nothing new. Officials have moved in recent years to change names of other controversial figures — including those tied to the Confederacy and Father Junipero Serra. But those have been slower and in some ways more deliberative.

In the immediate hours and days following the allegations against Chavez, many officials said it was important that communities respond immediately, and redirect the focus from Chavez to the larger movement. Their efforts also send a message that such behavior is unacceptable, they say.

On Thursday, L.A. Mayor Karen Bass and members of the City Council announced they would abandon the holiday honoring Chavez’s birthday and instead rename it “Farm Workers Day” to honor laborers who toil in the fields.

“I appreciate that my community has the integrity and the strength to reckon with these new revelations in a very expedient way, and as we do in Los Angeles,” said Los Angeles City Councilmember Monica Rodri-

[See Chavez, A14]

SoCal Marines, warships sent to Mideast

Trump says the U.S. is considering ‘winding down’ the war. Iran keeps up gulf attacks.

By GAVIN J. QUINTON

WASHINGTON — President Trump said Friday that the United States is considering “winding down” hostilities in the Middle East as the Pentagon is sending thousands of California-based Marines to the region and has requested billions in new funding for the Iran war. “We are getting very close to meeting our objectives as we consider winding down our great Military efforts in the Middle East with respect to the Terrorist Regime of Iran,” Trump wrote on Truth Social.

He listed a number of military aims he claimed were close to being accomplished, including destroying Iran’s military and nuclear capabilities. He said the Strait of Hormuz will “have to be guarded and policed” but provided no timeline or information detailing the fate of service members recently dispatched to the hostilities.

The Pentagon is sending three California-based warships and roughly 2,500 Marines to the Middle East, the second significant deployment in a week, the Associated Press and other news outlets reported Friday.

The three warships, the San Diego-based USS Boxer and two warships from the 11th Marine Expeditionary Unit, departed from Camp Pendleton on Wednesday.

They were being deployed for “routine training,” according to official Pentagon statements, but defense officials told various news outlets that the final destination is the Middle East, where the U.S. military has amassed about 50,000 troops in total.

A 2,500-strong Marine unit accompanied by the USS Tripoli warship launched from Japan on Saturday.

The Pentagon declined to comment on the deployments: “Due to operations security we do not discuss future or hypothetical movements,” a Pentagon spokesperson said in a statement Friday.

The major reinforcement [See Iran, A3]

Another shock to Wall Street

Oil prices rattle stock markets and erase hopes for possible cut in interest rates. BUSINESS, A11

Deportees from the U.S. are homeless and stateless

Migrants sent to unfamiliar cities deep inside Mexico

By KATE LINTHICUM

VILLAHERMOSA, Mexico — It was 2 a.m. when a bus carrying dozens of U.S. deportees heaved into this sweltering city in southern Mexico.

The Mexican immigration agents who had guarded the group on their three-day trip from the border said their charges, still dressed in the prison garb of detainees, were now free to go.

Alberto Rodríguez, 73, limped with a cane down a deserted industrial street. A stroke had left him perpetually foggy, unable to recall many details about his life beyond the fact that he had been born in Cuba and had spent nearly 50 years in the United States.

“Where am I?” he called out.

[See Mexico, A4]



ALEJANDRO CEGARRA For The Times MIGUEL Martínez Cruz, 65, a Cuban who was deported to Mexico, says he misses the pizza in the U.S.

Heat wave is latest event linked to climate change, experts say

By CLARA HARTER

The most destructive wildfires in Southern California history. The region’s wettest holiday season. The hottest March heat wave on record.

In the last 15 months, the Southland has seen a trio of extreme weather events, and UC climate scientist

Daniel Swain says there’s one clear through-line connecting them all.

“All of the superlative extremes we’ve seen in recent years — from extreme heat to extreme dryness to extreme wetness, and even the severe wildfires — they all have clear links to climate change,” he said.

The ongoing heat wave shattering dozens of tem-

perature records in Southern California is no exception, Swain said.

Climate change warms the atmosphere, raising baseline temperatures and making heat-trapping weather patterns more intense and longer-lasting. As a result, we see more frequent and more severe heat waves.

[See Heat, A14]

CHUCK NORRIS, 1940 – 2026

Star of ‘Walker, Texas Ranger,’ martial artist and internet meme

By EMILY ST. MARTIN



FREDERIC MEYLAN Sygma

ULTIMATE TOUGH GUY Norris most often played heroes who solved problems with their fists.

With his roundhouse kicks, tough-guy one-liners and a formidable moral compass, Chuck Norris delivered kick-ass heroes for years on screens large and small, cementing himself in pop culture back in the 1980s. Decades later, in the aughts, he earned new legions of millennial and Gen Z fans with the rise of “Chuck Norris Facts,” like “When Chuck Norris arrived at the gates of Heaven, St. Peter showed his ID to Chuck Norris.”

The martial artist and actor known for “The Way of the Dragon” and the long-running series “Walker, Texas Ranger” died Thursday morning in Hawaii, his family confirmed Friday. He was 86.

“It is with heavy hearts that our family shares the sudden passing of our beloved Chuck Norris yesterday morning,” the family said in a statement. “While we would like to keep the circumstances private, please know that he was surrounded by his family and was at peace.” [See Norris, A7]

CBS News to shut storied radio unit

By STEPHEN BATTAGLIO

In a stunning move, CBS News is shutting down its radio division, bringing to an end one of its most recognizable sources of news reporting after nearly 100 years on air.

CBS News announced Friday it will stop offering its radio service to its 700 affiliate stations on May 22.

“While this was a necessary decision, it was not an easy one,” the company said in a memo obtained by The Times. “A shift in radio station programming strategies, coupled with challenging economic realities, has made it impossible to continue the service.”

The announcement marked the end of an era at CBS, which follows years of cutbacks at the network.

CBS sold its own radio stations in 2017, but continued to offer hourly network newscasts to affiliate sta-

tions, including “World News Roundup,” which has been on the air since 1938. Legendary CBS News journalist Edward R. Murrow — who would become a nationally recognized anchor covering the international battlefields of World War II and the domestic Red Scare of the McCarthy era — delivered his first report on the program.

“World News Roundup” rose to prominence during World War II, when Murrow and other CBS News correspondents delivered live reports from Europe.

Robert Trout led the broadcast when it was launched and is considered by historians to be the first news anchor. Douglas Edwards, another esteemed veteran of CBS News, was at the microphone for the program from 1966 to 1988 when it was called “The World Tonight.”

“World News Roundup” is currently heard on KNX in Los Angeles, which also carries the hourly CBS newscasts.

While CBS News Radio is no longer a significant revenue generator, the service [See CBS News, A11]

Reality hits pause on TV career of ‘Bachelorette’

Taylor Frankie Paul was near her debut on dating series before her latest crossover attempt derailed. BUSINESS, A9

Doncic dials it up to 60 for Lakers

Star guard enters MVP conversation as James ties NBA games-played record in win over the Miami Heat. SPORTS, B12

Weather Partly sunny; warm. L.A. Basin: 88/59. B8

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U.S. Department of Treasury AN illustration of the coin released by the Treasury Department.

Mint can produce Trump gold coin

Panel approves commemorative currency, which critics denounce as an undemocratic act. NATION, A5

